

Hernán Ainsa

Senior Product Designer · UX Engineer

End-to-End Product Design · Design Systems · Research to Shipped Interface · Ships His Own Front-End

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PROFILE

Senior Product Designer. Fifteen years in software: nine leading end-to-end UX/UI for web, mobile and SaaS platforms — three of them designed from scratch — after seven building production front-end. I work from stakeholder discovery and information architecture through to high-fidelity UI and a shipped interface, on complex, domain-heavy operational tools: campaign planning, licence tracking, field inspection, maritime incident reporting.

What sets the work apart is that I also build it. I came into design from seven years of front-end engineering, and for the last two I have been implementing again (React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS) — which means design decisions get validated against what is actually buildable, and handoff stops being a translation loss. I build and maintain design systems — tokens, component libraries, accessibility — and use AI-assisted design-to-code workflows to shorten the distance between an approved design and a working product. PSPO I certified (Scrum.org).

CORE SKILLS

Product & UX Design: Stakeholder and user research, user interviews, personas, journey mapping, information architecture, user flows, wireframing, usability testing, MVP definition, feature prioritisation, competitive benchmarking, outcome-driven iteration

UI & Design Systems: High-fidelity UI, interaction design, interactive prototyping, design systems, component libraries, design tokens, style guides, accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA), responsive design

Front-End: React, Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, HTML5, CSS3, Ant Design, Git / GitHub, Vercel

Design-to-Code: Figma MCP → React pipeline, Claude Code, Cursor, token sync between Figma and codebase

Tools: Figma (Auto Layout, Variables, Dev Mode), Adobe XD, Affinity, Mural, Notion, PostHog (event tracking, conversion funnels)

Ways of working: Agile / Scrum (PSPO I), cross-functional collaboration with engineers, PMs and stakeholders

EXPERIENCE

Design Engineer

Jun 2025 — Present

Kier Studio — Self-employed · Remote

Independent practice: product interfaces designed in Figma and built in Next.js.

- Owned MVPs and marketing sites end to end — scope definition, UX, UI, implementation and delivery, working directly with the client through feedback rounds.
- Built a tokenised design system per project, keeping visual decisions in one place and in sync between the Figma file and the codebase.
- Used AI-assisted development (Figma MCP, Claude Code, Cursor) to compress the distance from prototype to working product.
- Instrumented product analytics (PostHog) to inform UX and conversion decisions after launch.

Senior UX/UI Designer — Consultant

May 2017 — Mar 2026

OZ Digital Consulting (AAJ Technologies) · Remote

Led end-to-end product design across OZ's consulting engagements — from discovery and stakeholder research through launch — for clients including Hard Rock, TopBuild, OnBoard and Groundworks.

- **Hard Rock — Marketing Planner.** Replaced a campaign process living in Excel and SQL scripts, maintained by a handful of spreadsheet experts, with a structured planner. Reverse-engineered the legacy logic into a data hierarchy (Plan → Jobs → Campaigns → Offers/Tiers) and designed the system around it. *Estimated impact:* –70% campaign creation time, +65% offers launched in the first month, –82% reported errors.
- **TopBuild — License Tracker.** Centralised hundreds of construction licences across multiple US states. Ran stakeholder and user research, built personas and journey maps, benchmarked competing tools, and scoped the MVP around real-time visibility for field operations. *Estimated impact:* –70% licence management time.

- **OZ — Strategic Value Model.** Replaced disconnected Excel and PowerPoint with a single visual model for comparing project impact by cost, effort and value. End-to-end research, discovery workshops, information architecture, four user roles defined up front, POC scoped to three core features. Built as an internal OZ tool, later sold on as a client service.
- **IssuTrax (OnBoard).** Joined mid-project to stabilise the design system before MVP launch, then led post-launch iteration — including a repeatable crew-feedback process prioritised by real impact rather than by who asked loudest.
- Implemented production front-end code (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React) on client projects, validating UI fidelity from inside the codebase instead of over a handoff.

Web UI Developer

Apr 2010 — May 2017

Globant · Rosario, Argentina

- Built responsive, accessible web applications in HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, jQuery and Angular.js for clients including Pizza Hut, Adidas and YPF.
- Worked in cross-functional Agile/Scrum teams; applied SEO, accessibility and performance standards in production.

Visual Designer & Front-End Developer

2008 — 2015

ciudadEsférica · Freelance · Rosario, Argentina

- Web design, front-end development and visual identity for clients including John Deere and Holy Beer Hotel.

SELECTED WORK

Case studies: hernan-ainsa.vercel.app/en/work

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Professional Scrum Product Owner I (PSPO I) — Scrum.org	2024
Product Design Complete Process Bootcamp — Uxopedia	2020
User Experience: The Beginner's Guide — Interaction Design Foundation	2019
Associate Degree in Graphic Design and Illustration — ISCV, Rosario (<i>incomplete</i>)	2007 — 2008

LANGUAGES

Spanish — Native
English — Advanced (B2). Fluent for daily work, technical discussion and interviews.